MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM
MGU-UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATION March 2026 -Fourth SEMESTER
Q.P. 25901526- Discipline Specific Elective (DSE) - MG4DSESWK200 - Perspectives Of Community Development

Part A Very Short Answer Answer all questions Each question carries 1 marks

1. Name the founder of the Sriniketan Rural Reconstruction Programme. [K] / [CO1] -1 marks

Founder of the Sriniketan Rural Reconstruction Programme: Rabindranath Tagore

2. Define rural social stratification. [K] / [CO3] 1 marks

It refers to the hierarchical division of rural society into different social groups based on caste, class, occupation, land ownership, and status.

3. State one feature of the Indian urban development model. [K] / [CO4] 1 marks

Rapid urbanization with a mix of planned and unplanned (informal) settlements.

4. Give examples of any two urban livelihood programmes. [K] / [CO5] 1 marks

National Urban Livelihoods Mission (NULM)
Prime Minister's Employment Generation Programme (PMEGP)

5. Define Panchayati Raj Institution (PRI). [K] / [CO3] 1 marks

A system of local self-government in rural India where elected representatives govern at village, block, and district levels.

6. State one objective of the Integrated Rural Development Programme (IRDP). [K] / [CO2] 1 marks

To alleviate rural poverty by providing income-generating assets and self-employment opportunities to the poor

7. Define Integrated Rural Development. [K] / [CO3] 1 marks

A holistic approach to improving the economic and social conditions of rural people by combining various development programmes.

8. Define slum. K] / [CO4] 1 marks

A densely populated urban area characterized by poor housing, inadequate infrastructure, and unsanitary living conditions.

9. Cite two functions of Kudumbashree. [K] / [CO6]- 1 marks

- Promoting women's self-help groups and empowerment
- Supporting income-generating activities and poverty eradication

10. Define Rural Development. [K] / [CO3] 1 marks

The process of improving the quality of life and economic well-being of people living in rural areas.

Part B - Short Answer Answer any 5 questions Each question carries 3 marks

11. Explain why community participation is important in development. - U] / [CO1] **3 marks**

- ✓ Ensures **local needs and priorities** are properly identified and addressed.
- ✓ Promotes **ownership and sustainability** of development programmes.
- ✓ Strengthens **empowerment and democratic decision-making** at the grassroots level.

12. Explain the social objectives of rural development. - [U] / [CO3] **3 marks**

- Improve **quality of life** through education, health, and sanitation.
- Reduce **poverty and social inequalities** (caste, gender, class).
- Promote **social justice and inclusion** of marginalized groups.

13. Explain the concept of urban governance. [U] / [CO4] **3 marks**

- ✓ Refers to **management of urban areas** by government, private sector, and civil society.
- ✓ Focuses on **service delivery** (water, housing, transport, sanitation).
- ✓ Emphasizes **participation, transparency, and accountability** in city administration.

14. Interpret the impact of employment programmes on rural poverty. -[A] / [CO6] - **3 marks**
- ❖ Generate **income and livelihood opportunities** for rural poor.
- ❖ Reduce **seasonal unemployment and migration** to cities.
- ❖ Improve **standard of living and economic security**.

15. Discuss the significance of economic indicators in assessing development. - [U] / [CO2]- **3 marks**
- Help measure **economic growth** (GDP, per capita income).
- Indicate **living standards and inequality levels**.
- Aid in **policy planning and evaluation** of development programmes.

16. Apply the concept of urban development to a developing city.- [A] / [CO4]- **3 marks**
- ✓ Improve **infrastructure** (roads, housing, sanitation, transport).
- ✓ Encourage **sustainable planning** (green spaces, waste management).
- ✓ Promote **inclusive growth** by addressing slums and informal sectors.

17. Interpret the importance of housing schemes in cities- **[A] / [CO5]- 3 marks**
- ➢ Provide **affordable housing** for low-income groups.
- ➢ Help reduce **slums and urban poverty**.
- ➢ Improve **health, safety, and living conditions**.

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Part C Short Essay Answer any 3 questions Each question carries 5 marks

18. Demonstrate how local leadership can help achieve the objectives of community development. -[A] / [CO1]- **5 marks**
- Mobilizes **community participation** and encourages collective action.
- Identifies **local needs and resources** for better planning.
- Acts as a **link between people and government agencies**.
- Promotes **awareness and implementation** of development programmes.
- Ensures **conflict resolution and social cohesion** within the community.

19. Examine the causes and consequences of agrarian distress. **-[A] / [CO3] -5 marks**

Causes:
- Dependence on **monsoon and climate uncertainties**.
- Rising **cost of inputs** (seeds, fertilizers, irrigation).
- **Indebtedness** due to lack of institutional credit.

Consequences:
- Increase in **farmer poverty and migration**.
- Extreme cases leading to **farmer suicides** and social instability.

20. Illustrate the Nagarapalika Act provisions to urban local administration. **- A] / [CO4]- 5 marks**
(74th Constitutional Amendment Act)
- Establishes **Urban Local Bodies (Municipalities)** for governance.
- Provides for **elected representatives** at city levels.
- Ensures **devolution of powers and responsibilities**.
- Includes **reservation for women and weaker sections**.
- Assigns functions like **urban planning, sanitation, water supply**.

21. Analyse the strategies of poverty eradication programmes in India. - [An] / [CO5]- **5 marks**
- ➢ Promotion of **self-employment and skill development**.
- ➢ Implementation of **wage employment programmes**.
- ➢ Focus on **inclusive growth and targeting vulnerable groups**.
- ➢ Provision of **financial inclusion and microcredit**.
- ➢ Integration of **health, education, and social welfare schemes**.

22. Examine the infrastructure challenges faced in rural areas and their implications**.-** **[A] / [CO3] – 5 marks**
- ➢ Poor **transport and road connectivity** limits market access.
- ➢ Lack of **health and educational facilities** affects human development.
- ➢ Inadequate **irrigation and power supply** impacts agriculture.
- ➢ Limited **digital connectivity** restricts information access.
- ➢ Results in **migration, poverty, and regional inequality**.

Part D Essay Answer any 2 questions Each question carries 15 marks [

23. Examine the role of political and administrative barriers in limiting effective community development. **Political Barriers** a) **Lack of political will-** Government authorities may not prioritize community development programmes, leading to weak implementation.	An] / [CO2] 7 marks

b) **Political interference-** Decisions are often influenced by political interests rather than community needs.
c) **Corruption and favoritism-** Misuse of funds and biased allocation of resources reduce programme effectiveness.
d) **Elite dominance-** Local powerful groups control benefits, excluding marginalized communities.
e) **Policy instability-** Frequent changes in policies with changing governments disrupt continuity.
f) **Vote-bank politics-** Development programmes are sometimes designed to gain electoral advantage rather than genuine development.

Administrative Barriers — 6 marks

7. **Bureaucratic delays-** Lengthy procedures slow down decision-making and implementation.
a) **Lack of coordination -**Poor coordination among departments leads to duplication or gaps in services.
b) **Centralized decision-making -**Top-down approach ignores local needs and realities.
c) **Inadequate trained personnel-** Lack of skilled staff affects planning and execution.
d) **Weak monitoring and evaluation -**Poor supervision leads to inefficiency and corruption.
e) **Communication gaps-** Ineffective communication between officials and communities reduces participation.
f) **Rigid administrative structure -**Lack of flexibility prevents innovation and adaptation.
g) **Resource constraints-** Insufficient funds and infrastructure limit programme reach.

Impact on Community Development — 2 marks

a) **These barriers result in** poor participation, inefficient resource utilization, exclusion of vulnerable groups, and failure to achieve development goals**.**

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24. Examine the role of trusteeship and decentralization in Gandhian rural development.- [An] / [CO3]

(Trusteeship in Gandhian Rural Development — 7 marks

a) **Concept of trusteeship-** Wealthy individuals should act as **trustees of their wealth** for the welfare of society.
b) **Reduction of inequality-** Promotes equitable distribution of resources without violent conflict.
c) **Moral responsibility-** Emphasizes ethical use of wealth and social accountability.
d) **Non-exploitative economy-** Discourages exploitation of labour and resources.
e) **Voluntary sharing -**Encourages voluntary redistribution rather than forced confiscation.
f) **Class harmony-** Aims to reduce conflict between rich and poor.
g) **Focus on social welfare-** Prioritizes community well-being over individual profit.

Decentralization in Gandhian Rural Development — 7 marks

a) **Gram Swaraj (village self-rule)-** Villages function as **self-sufficient units** of governance.
b) **Local self-governance-**Power is vested in village institutions like Panchayats.
c) **People's participation -** Encourages active involvement of citizens in decision-making.
d) **Efficient resource utilization-** Local resources are used based on local needs.
e) **Transparency and accountability-** Decision-making at the grassroots ensures better accountability.
f) **Reduction of bureaucratic control-** Limits over-centralization and delays.
g) **Promotion of self-reliance-** Villages become economically and socially independent.

Combined Role in Rural Development — 1 mark

➢ Together, trusteeship and decentralization promote **equity, participation, sustainability, and inclusive development**, forming the foundation of Gandhian rural reconstruction.

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25. Examine the interrelationship between migration and urban social disorganisation.- [An] / [CO4]

Migration as a Cause of Urban Social Disorganisation — 6 mark

a) **Rapid population growth-** Influx of migrants leads to overcrowding in cities.
b) **Housing shortages and slums-** Migrants often settle in informal settlements with poor conditions.
c) **Pressure on urban infrastructure-** Overburdened water supply, sanitation, transport, and healthcare systems.
d) **Unemployment and informal sector growth-** Limited job opportunities push migrants into insecure work.
e) **Cultural heterogeneity-** Diverse backgrounds may lead to cultural clashes and weak social cohesion.
f) **Weak social control-** Absence of strong community bonds increases deviant behaviour.

Urban Social Disorganisation Affecting Migrants — 5 mark

a) **Social exclusion and marginalization-** Migrants face discrimination and lack of integration. b) **Poor living conditions-** Slums lack basic amenities, affecting health and dignity. c) **Crime and insecurity-** Disorganised environments often see higher crime rates. d) **Family disintegration-** Migration may separate families or create stress within them. e) **Limited access to services-** Education, healthcare, and welfare services are often inaccessible. **Interrelationship (Two-way Process)** a) **Cycle of poverty-** Migration leads to urban poverty, which reinforces disorganisation. b) **Mutual reinforcement-** Disorganisation attracts vulnerable migrants and worsens conditions. c) **Strain on governance-** Urban institutions struggle to manage growing populations. d) **Impact on sustainable development-** Unplanned growth undermines long-term urban stability. .	4 mark
26. Estimate the effectiveness of livelihood promotion strategies in enhancing rural income- **Effectiveness of Livelihood Promotion Strategies** a) **Income generation opportunities-** Provide sustainable sources of income through self-employment and wage employment. b) **Diversification of livelihoods-** Reduce dependence on agriculture by promoting non-farm activities like small enterprises and services. c) **Skill development and capacity building-** Training programmes enhance employability and productivity. d) **Promotion of micro-enterprises-** Encourages rural entrepreneurship and local economic growth. e) **Access to credit and financial inclusion-** Microfinance and banking services help the poor invest in income-generating activities. f) **Strengthening Self-Help Groups (SHGs)-** SHGs promote savings, credit access, and collective economic activities. g) **Women empowerment-** Increases women's participation in economic activities and decision-making. h) **Improved market linkages-** Better access to markets helps in getting fair prices for products. i) **Reduction in poverty levels-** Increased income contributes to better living standards. j) **Employment generation-** Reduces unemployment and underemployment in rural areas. **Limitations and Challenges** a) **Unequal access to benefits-** Marginalized groups may not fully benefit. b) **Lack of awareness and training-** Beneficiaries may not utilize opportunities effectively. c) **Market constraints-** Poor infrastructure and weak demand limit income growth. d) **Implementation gaps-**Inefficiency and corruption reduce programme impact. e) **Sustainability issues-** Some initiatives fail without continuous support.	[E] / [CO6 10 marks 5 marks

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